CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Standard Bank × ASCO

ASCO Youth Digital Skills and Community Learning Hubs

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: South Africa; proposed pilot in a suitably assessed underserved community in Limpopo (potentially Vhembe), subject to Standard Bank and community/government validation.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Standard Bank** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **ASCO Youth Digital Skills and Community Learning Hubs**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** ASCO Youth Digital Skills and Community Learning Hubs in South Africa; proposed pilot in a suitably assessed underserved community in Limpopo (potentially Vhembe), subject to Standard Bank and community/government validation., benefiting Proposed: underserved South African youth, with priority to unemployed or out-of-school young people and local community facilitators; final age range, cohort size and selection criteria should be agreed through needs assessment and safeguarding review. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Standard Bank's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
ASCO Youth Digital Skills and Community Learning Hubs

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
South Africa; proposed pilot in a suitably assessed underserved community in Limpopo (potentially Vhembe), subject to Standard Bank and community/government validation.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: underserved South African youth, with priority to unemployed or out-of-school young people and local community facilitators; final age range, cohort size and selection criteria should be agreed through needs assessment and safeguarding review.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: 1 community-based pilot delivered over an agreed funding period, with a documented baseline and endline.
- Proposed: train 100 youth participants in foundational digital, employability and civic/community problem-solving skills.
- Proposed: train 10 local facilitators or mentors and provide a reusable learning toolkit for community delivery.
- Proposed: deliver at least 12 structured group sessions and 4 community-led practical projects, subject to venue, staffing and safeguarding feasibility.
- Proposed: track attendance, completion, skills gains and participant feedback, and submit a narrative and financial report aligned with Standard Bank’s beneficiary-reporting requirements.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Standard Bank?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- Standard Bank South Africa's CSI programme prioritises better access to education to support economic and social transformation, including skills and knowledge for the world of work.
- The official 2025 Report to Society states that Standard Bank invested R143 million in South African CSI programmes, focused on access to quality education including digital skills, disaster relief and community-based disaster management, and employee community involvement/skills sharing.
- The 2024 Sustainability Disclosures Report identifies financial inclusion, business growth and job creation, climate change mitigation and adaptation, and infrastructure development as the Group's material societal-impact areas.
- The South Africa CSI policy summary prioritises local need, with focus on SDG 4 quality education, SDG 3 health and wellbeing, and SDG 8 decent work and economic growth, especially entrepreneurship/SME support.
- The CSI policy summary says Standard Bank contracts NGO partners for longer-term interventions, allows charitable donations including disaster/humanitarian relief, and supports employee contributions such as volunteering and skills sharing; CSI funds may only be used for not-for-profit activities.
- The 2025 report says country operations develop their own CSI policies and programmes within the Group framework and work with government departments and social partners for effective, sustainable delivery. South Africa allocates 0.6% of NPAT to CSI and 0.4% to consumer education.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R100,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

No dedicated public CSI application route was found in the reviewed official sources. For an initial route enquiry, use Standard Bank Sponsorship at Sponsorship@standardbank.co.za or +27 11 636 1061, clearly asking to be directed to the South Africa CSI team; for sustainability-related routing, the 2024 report lists GroupSustainability@standardbank.co.za. ASCO may also provide its own contact details (+27 76 757 5773; https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/) in the enquiry, but these are not Standard Bank application channels.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- The sources do not confirm that Standard Bank is currently accepting unsolicited CSI proposals, that it will fund ASCO, or that it has any commitment to this project.
- The official CSI policy summary reviewed was approved in September 2021 with a stated August 2023 review date; confirm the current South Africa policy, budget cycle, due-diligence requirements and decision-maker before submission.
- CSI is for not-for-profit activities and beneficiaries must report on activities for the funding period; the policy also prohibits donations or matching funding where a Standard Bank employee serves on the beneficiary organisation’s board or has a declared conflict of interest.
- Standard Bank’s documented examples include education, ECD, digital skills, disaster relief and community involvement; a general youth/community-development request without a clear education or skills outcome may be a weaker fit.
- The Vhembe/Limpopo example is evidence of prior geographic activity, not a promise of a new partnership or preferred location. Confirm geography and whether capital/infrastructure, stipends, equipment or operating costs are eligible.

- Do not claim Section 18A approval, completed ASCO results, existing partnerships, or Standard Bank funding/commitments. The provided ASCO contact and website were not treated as independently verified company-source facts.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Standard Bank** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.standardbank.co.za/southafrica/personal/about-us/corporate-social-investment
2. https://www.standardbank.com/static_file/StandardBankGroup/filedownloads/RTS/2025/SBG_Report_To_Society_2025.pdf
3. https://www.standardbank.com/static_file/StandardBankGroup/filedownloads/RTS/2024/SBG_SustainabilityDisclosuresReport2024.pdf
4. https://www.standardbank.com/static_file/StandardBankGroup/filedownloads/RTS/2022/ESG_PolicySummary_CSI.pdf
5. https://www.standardbank.co.za/southafrica/news-and-media/newsroom/partnership-with-local-communities-in-limpopo-to-deliver-education-centres
6. https://sponsorships.standardbank.com/sbgs/sponsorship/contact-us

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.